Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 29 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Fog	Overcast	Light drizzle
17° 11°	15° 10°	15° 10°	14° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Entertainer Russell Brand has told his trial that sexual consent is 'fundamental'.**
Mr Brand is giving evidence in his own defence at his trial, where he faces charges including rape and assault, all of which he denies.
CRIME · UK

2 **Tommy Robinson, whose real name is Stephen Yaxley-Lennon, has been found guilty of harassing two Daily Mail journalists.**
The 43-year-old was convicted after a week-long trial at Southwark Crown Court. The verdict was delivered yesterday.
CRIME · UK

3 **The King has acknowledged the 'suffering of the past' as his nine-day Caribbean tour gets underway.**
His Majesty will visit three countries during the tour: the Bahamas, Guyana, and Antigua and Barbuda. He made the comments upon arrival.
ROYAL · UK

4 **A terminally ill mum, Rachael Field from Rhondda Cynon Taf, has been refused a Personal Independence Payment, despite being unable to talk, walk, or dress herself.**
Ms Field had her tongue and voicebox removed and her windpipe reconstructed. Her family are appealing the decision.
HEALTH · UK

5 **A court has heard that a man accused of a train attack in Huntingdon asked a passenger 'do you want to die?'.**
Anthony Williams denies 14 counts of attempted murder, including ten on a train in Cambridgeshire. The trial is ongoing.
CRIME · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Music fans hoping to see Sam Fender have faced disappointment, after pre-sale tickets for his Newcastle shows were hit by a 'bot attack'.**

Sam Fender himself confirmed the 'sophisticated' attack affected the website selling tickets. New pre-sale dates are expected soon.

ON AIR — Have you ever been caught out by bots when trying to get concert tickets? It's so frustrating!

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **A mum has quit her job as a lawyer to become a voice artist for a new Netflix cartoon.**

Emily McGonagle, 42, decided to change careers after watching shows like Peppa Pig and Paw Patrol with her children. She'll be voicing a character in an upcoming preschool series.

ON AIR — What a brave career change! Would you ever take such a leap for a dream job?

TV · COMING UP

3 **'Babydoll' singer, who recently scored a UK number one, says his life will 'never be the same again'.**

The singer is finding genuine joy in life after a difficult period led to him quitting music. He’s now back with a bang and a chart-topping hit.

ON AIR — It's wonderful to hear such a positive comeback story, isn't it? What's your favourite comeback track?

MUSIC · NOW

4 **Fans of the 'A Court of Thorns and Roses' book series are putting real life on hold for the latest release.**

Some dedicated fans are even taking the week off work to fully immerse themselves in the new instalment. It's certainly a popular fantasy series!

ON AIR — Have you ever been so excited for a book or film release that you've cleared your schedule? What was it for?

BOOKS · NOW

5 **A new documentary is exploring the rise of 'new black spaces' in the music industry.**

It highlights how young black creatives are continuing a tradition of carving out spaces to dance, connect, and belong. The film features several emerging artists.

ON AIR — It's fantastic to see new spaces emerging in music. What kind of new music scenes are you excited about at the moment?

MUSIC · COMING UP

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **All Spanish cup matches scheduled for yesterday were suspended after a tragic train collision near Madrid.**

At least 68 people were killed in the crash, leading to the suspension of all 24 Copa del Rey matches as a mark of respect. Our thoughts are with everyone affected.

ON AIR — A truly awful tragedy. It's a reminder that some things are far more important than sport.

FOOTBALL · EUROPE

2 **Arsenal are set to appeal against Max Dowman's red card from their Carabao Cup defeat against Fleetwood Town.**

The young player was sent off during Tuesday's match, which Arsenal ultimately lost on penalties. The club feels the decision was harsh.

ON AIR — Do you think VAR should be used in all cup competitions to avoid these kinds of controversial decisions?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Burnley have appointed Fabio Celestini as their new head coach, following the departure of Nicky Hayen.**

Celestini, formerly the boss at Basel, takes the reins just four days after the previous head coach left. It's a quick turnaround for the club.

ON AIR — A new manager always brings new hope! Do you think this is the right appointment for Burnley?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **British light-welterweight Adam Azim is set for a December return to the ring against Gabriel Gollaz Valenzuela.**

The fight is scheduled to take place at London's Copper Box on December 4th. Azim will be hoping to continue his impressive run.

ON AIR — Exciting news for British boxing fans! Who are you backing in this fight?

BOXING · UK

5 **Fleetwood Town manager Matt Lawlor could not hide his delight after his team knocked Premier League champions Arsenal out of the EFL Cup.**

Fleetwood, despite being 83 league places below Arsenal, secured a famous victory on penalties. Lawlor called it the 'biggest night in the club's history'.

ON AIR — What a giant-killing! Do you love seeing the underdogs triumph in cup competitions?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **Many of us are finding a surprising amount of satisfaction in the humble art of 'doodle cleaning'.**
   This is where you casually tidy up small areas while on the phone or deep in thought, transforming minor clutter into neat piles without really meaning to.

2. **The simple pleasure of 'listening to the rain' is being rediscovered as a popular way to relax and unwind.**
   Whether it's a gentle pitter-patter or a full-on downpour, the natural rhythm is proving to be a perfect backdrop for quiet moments.

3. **There's a growing trend for people to create 'miniature indoor landscapes' using houseplants and tiny decorations.**
   These small, self-contained worlds are bringing a touch of outdoor tranquility into living spaces, proving quite popular for those who love a bit of green.

4. **The delightful feeling of 'finding a perfect parking spot' without any hassle is being celebrated as a small daily victory.**
   It's one of those minor miracles that can genuinely brighten your day, saving time and stress in equal measure.

5. **Many are embracing the soothing ritual of 'watching a kettle boil' as a moment of calm in a busy day.**
   It's a pause, a brief moment of anticipation before a warm cuppa, and it seems people are consciously enjoying that simple process.

6. **The unexpected charm of 'discovering a new shortcut' on a familiar route is bringing a spark of adventure to daily commutes.**
   Even a slight detour that shaves off a minute or two can feel like a clever secret, making the journey a little more interesting.

7. **There's a quiet appreciation emerging for the intricate patterns found in 'leaf veins' and natural textures.**
   Taking a moment to notice the delicate designs in nature, even on a fallen leaf, is becoming a source of simple wonder for many.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE PACKET A GENTLE SHAKE TO GAUGE THE CRISP-TO-AIR RATIO!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new pack of biscuits, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: CAREFULLY ARRANGING THEM ON A PLATE IN ORDER OF 'MOST DESIRED' TO 'LEAST DESIRED'!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' just instantly makes you feel cosy or happy?**
  It could be the sound of rain on the window, the distant chime of an ice cream van, or even the gentle hum of your fridge. What's that one sound that always brings a smile to your face, and why?

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, for some reason, we're surprisingly protective of or attached to.**
  It might be a favourite mug, a well-loved spatula, or even a particular tea towel. What's yours, and what makes it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that sloths can hold their breath for longer than dolphins? A sloth can hold its breath for up to 40 minutes, while a dolphin can only manage about 10 minutes.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the iconic 'Keep Calm and Carry On' posters from World War Two were originally designed with glow-in-the-dark ink for blackout conditions?

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£75 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£75 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's oldest known living tree is Methuselah, a Great Basin bristlecone pine in California, estimated to be over 4,850 years old.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The 'king' in a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 29 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 302 of the year, 63 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abraham of Rostov; Christian feast day: Blessed Chiara Badano; Christian feast day: Colman mac Duagh; Christian feast day: Douai Martyrs. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Michael Passons, American singer-songwriter
- 1984 — Chris Baio, American bass player
- 1949 — James Williamson, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1948 — Kate Jackson, American actress, director, and producer
- 1961 — Randy Jackson, American singer-songwriter and dancer
- 1980 — Ben Foster, American actor
- 1944 — Denny Laine, English singer-songwriter and musician (died 2023)
- 1957 — Dan Castellaneta, American actor, voice artist, comedian, singer and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2014 — A mud slide; the 2014 Badulla landslide, in south-central Sri Lanka, kills at least 16 people, and leaves hundreds of people missing.
- 2015 — China announces the end of its one-child policy after 35 years.
- 2012 — Hurricane Sandy hits the east coast of the United States, killing hundreds, while leaving nearly $70 billion in damages and causing major power outages.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1972 — The three surviving perpetrators of the Munich massacre are released from prison in exchange for the hostages of the hijacked Lufthansa Flight 615.
- 1986 — British Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher opens the last stretch of the M25 motorway.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1998 — In South Africa, the Truth and Reconciliation Commission presents its report, which condemns both sides for committing atrocities.
- 2008 — A pair of deadly earthquakes hits Baluchistan, Pakistan, killing 215.

- 2014 — A mud slide; the 2014 Badulla landslide, in south-central Sri Lanka, kills at least 16 people, and leaves hundreds of people missing.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 30 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 303 of the year, 62 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Declaration of the Slovak Nation (Slovakia); Christian feast day: Ethelnoth (Egelnoth) the Good; Christian feast day: Blessed Benvenuta Bojani; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins (Catholic, Ireland, Society of Jesus). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Ashley Barnes, Austrian-English footballer
- 1984 — David Mooney, Irish footballer
- 1973 — Michael Oakes, English footballer and manager
- 1970 — Nia Long, American actress
- 1951 — Harry Hamlin, American actor
- 1961 — Larry Wilmore, American comedian and television host
- 1956 — Juliet Stevenson, English actress
- 1953 — Charles Martin Smith, American actor, director, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1944 — Holocaust: Anne and Margot Frank are deported from Auschwitz to the Bergen-Belsen concentration camp, where they die from disease the following year, shortly before the end of WWII.
- 1947 — The General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT), the foundation of the World Trade Organization (WTO), is founded.
- 1975 — Forty-five people are killed when Inex-Adria Aviopromet Flight 450 crashes into Suchdol, Prague, while on approach to Prague Ruzyně Airport (now Václav Havel Airport Prague) in Czechoslovakia (present-day Czech Republic).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2013 — Forty-five people are killed and seven injured after a bus catches fire in Mahabubnagar district, Andhra Pradesh (present-day Telangana), India.
- 1944 — Holocaust: Anne and Margot Frank are deported from Auschwitz to the Bergen-Belsen concentration camp, where they die from disease the following year, shortly before the end of WWII.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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